

StoryDogs Prompt Cards

24 idea starters • Print single-sided at 100% • Cut on the dotted lines

Offer one card that matches the stuck step. Read it aloud if needed. Students can talk, draw, change the suggestion, or choose another idea.

01 WHO?

Draw first

Sketch a character. Point to one detail and tell a partner what it suggests about them.

02 WHO?

A surprising skill

What strange skill could your character have? When might it be useful?

03 WHO?

A small worry

What makes your character nervous? It can be something other people find easy.

04 WHO?

Someone to follow

Think of an animal, person, or object you notice often. What could make them an interesting character?

05 LIFE / WANT

Somewhere you know

For practice, borrow a familiar place: your classroom, a park, or your kitchen. What is an ordinary day like there?

06 LIFE / WANT

Say it first

Tell a partner: "My character wants ____ because ____." Your partner can repeat it while you write or draw.

07 LIFE / WANT

One important wish

What would make your character say, "I really hope this happens"? Why do they care?

08 LIFE / WANT

Before the surprise

What does your character usually do? Which part of that routine could a problem interrupt?

StoryDogs Prompt Cards

Cards 9-16 of 24 • Cut on the dotted lines

09 UH-OH!

Something changes

What could arrive, disappear, or stop working in the life you have already described?

10 UH-OH!

A reason to act

Why can't your character simply ignore what happened?

11 UH-OH!

Their first choice

What does your character decide to do about this change? What might happen because of that choice?

12 TROUBLE

A snag in the plan

What gets in the way of the choice your character just made?

13 TROUBLE

Try and see

What could your character try first? Could it help a little and cause another problem?

14 TROUBLE

Talk it through

Tell a partner what just happened. Ask them, "What would be difficult about that?" Choose an idea that fits.

15 TROUBLE

Something already there

Look at your character's worry or ordinary world. Could something you already invented create trouble now?

16 WORSE!

Turn up the trouble

How could the same problem grow? Try less time, fewer supplies, or someone losing trust.

StoryDogs Prompt Cards

Cards 17-24 of 24 • Cut on the dotted lines

17 WORSE!

Why this matters

If the plan fails now, what might your character lose that they really care about?

18 WORSE!

Follow the footprints

Read TROUBLE aloud. What could happen because of that? Keep a thread connecting the two steps.

19 CLIMAX

Their move

What can your character choose or try at the biggest moment? Let them help shape what happens.

20 CLIMAX

Use what is there

Could a skill, object, friend, or lesson from earlier help now? How would your character use it?

21 CLIMAX

A different choice

What would be hard for your character to do at the start? Could they try it now?

22 CHANGE

Then and now

At the beginning, my character _____. Now they _____. What changed between those moments?

23 CHANGE

Show the change

What small action could show your character's change without announcing a lesson?

24 CHANGE

A new ordinary day

Picture tomorrow. What will your character do differently? What might still be a little messy?